

dividuals do not fill these fields in the name of agility. This however does not create accountability in progressing these prospects down the funnel in a predictable manner. |

| Check the date of opportunity creation. | Creation of the opportunity should occur when you're engaged with the prospect and have begun the qualification process. There will sometimes be a child or related opp that needs to be created based on needs discovered during the IQM with AE. Should that be the case, the created child/related opp should have the IQM activity as a related task on it. | Explain that creating opps as soon as engagement occurs will lead to better management of a BDRs/SDRs pipeline. |

| Check to see if there is a contact associated to the opp and that there's meaningful engagement prior to the opp being created. | Our standard process requires that we work specific leads and that we convert the main contact person to a contact/opportunity upon qualification. | Explain that this best practice will help with measuring and moving an opportunity further down the pipeline because of accurately being able to communicate the decision-making team from the prospect's side. |

| If activity shows up on the record, and the activity is a connected call with notes, verify that the activity matches in Groove. | Activities on SFDC can be edited freely and therefore questioned by our audit team. | Explain that Groove is a SSoT that can be used as irrefutable proof of outreach. Even if other systems fail, Groove is always used as the last back-up. |

| If activity matches, check that activity happened in accordance with our Actively Working Rules Of Engagement (RoE). | Team members from both Sales and Marketing are expected to contribute pipeline only within their assigned territory. | Explain that making sure that being aligned to the RoE will not create any contingencies when measuring pipeline. |

Typical Red Flags

1. Opportunity Source: Sales Qualified Source should be SDR generated if not validate that there is a sourcing case documented.
2. Created by: The XDR should create the opportunity, if not, there should be a written explanation
3. Did the XDR set and complete a meeting on the same day without previous activity?
4. Are there duplicate opportunities?
5. Is NetARR missing?

Directors, Ops and JB will select random opps each month to audit and ensure audit process is being followed

Best practices to ensure credit for SAO

1. Add all leads to Flows, if you're reaching out to them.
2. Make sure your activity is logged that shows how you drove the meaningful engagement that led to the opportunity.
3. Populate all qualification fields
4. If activity was a phone call or a zoom call, log notes at the time of call
5. If a meeting was set, make sure you create a stage 0 opportunity prior to the meeting, populate fields during/afterwards. If person will likely web direct, keep opp in your name and update next steps, ensure that prospect is guided to web-direct using the Flow here, as per the conversation here.
6. If engagement is in LinkedIn or Whatsapp, take a picture and attach to chatter/opp
7. If activity happened at an event, make sure that immediately following the event, you create a stage 0 opportunity and send follow up email that recaps the conversation that took place

Reports

1. SAO Report for SDRs

1. SAO Report BDRs

Our Complementary Resources

Best Practices for Outbound BDRs

Cold-Calling and Email Checklist

Our cold-calling best practices typically consist of 4 elements. A pattern interrupt, an elevator pitch and, if required, objection/trap-setting questions and Up-Front Contracts.

To be effective, these need to be customized to the individuals we call as per the logic below:

- Different Geographical Business Cultures
- Personality Type as per the DISC model
- Individual's Role and Responsibilities
- Business' Needs and Objectives

Call Scripts

You can find three examples of our cold call scripts in the description of the BDR 101 Level Up Course

The main documentation may be found [here](#) and the library of resources [here](#).

Up-Front Contract

Typically used for scheduled calls and Up-Front Contracts. UFCs can also be used as a defense mechanism when cold calling does not go as planned. For cold-calling, UFCs are used when the prospect can commit to 15' at the time of the call. If they commit to a 15' for a later time, UFCs are used to open the call and set the agenda then.

Explore the main documentation [here](#).

Decision Maker Discovery

The questions below are suggestions to be used while doing a discovery call, in order to identify the decision making process, and to meet the outbound accepted SAO as per the guidelines [here](#).

- Who gets involved while evaluating a tool at {{company}}?
- Would you expect anyone to challenge your initiative, and if so can I help by connecting with anyone else on your end?
- If you as a {{title}} wanted to purchase GitLab, what process internally would you have to follow, and how can we help you navigate it?
- What challenges do you expect to face when trying to pitch this change internally? Who has a say in this and what do they care about the most?

Email Writing Cheat Sheet

The table below shows the Command of the Message Email Writing Checklist.

It aims to outline the structure of the emails we write to prospects. Emails should be written in each person's language and tone and make sure to include the CoM frameworks as per the outline below. You can find additional resources [here](#).

Subject Line	

Personalized	- Use Prospect's name, Company name, or colleague's name. - Relate to their situation: Use recent company initiatives, technologies they use, Projects they have planned etc.
Curiosity and Urgency	- Provide an image of their future situation: Guide the reader to imagine how their situation could change. - Use compelling events to give a clear image of where they are currently.
CoM	- Proof Points: Quote Case Studies or other customers. - How We Do it Better: Make use of our defensible differentiators.
Opening Line	
Avoid cliches	- Stand out: Avoid losing email real-estate with cliché phrases like "just following up" or "hope all is well". - Brand yourself: Demonstrate that you have an understanding of the reader's current situation and a clear idea of his required solutions.
CoM	- Before Scenarios: Paint a clear image of their current situation and how that is causing them professional or personal pain. - After Scenarios/PBOs: Tie the current situation with a clear image of a future situation that's beneficial for the business and the individual.
Main Body	
Addressing Questions and Information provided	- No Free Consulting: Answer questions just enough to give a narrative to your email and tie into the CTA. - No Transactional Answers: Don't make the reader feel like he's interacting with an online form, a robot, or a sleazy salesman that doesn't care.
CoM	- Discovery Questions: determine which discovery questions tie into their current situation, questions asked or information provided. - Trap-Setting Questions: if competitor technology or objections come up, use trap-setting questions to guide the reader into understanding our differentiators.
CTA	
Clear Next Step, Agenda and benefit	- Valuable: phrase your CTA in a way that's clearly valuable to the reader and his specific situation. - Defined: outline what will happen in the next step and how long will it take
CoM	- Measurable: present metrics or PBOs that will be covered in the next step

Additionally, you can use the matrix below as a quick-cheet to determine what datapoints can be used for personalization.

Location	Information
-----	-----

LinkedIn	- Have they recently been promoted? - What are the specific

responsibilities stated on their page you are trying to help them with? |

| Company strategy from website | - What are the company's strategic initiatives? (become more agile?, improve internal business systems?, focus on speed to market on delivery? Streamlining expenditure?) |

| Google search name of contact | - Do they have any blogs? - Have they featured in any articles? - Have they any personal achievements celebrated? - Do they have any side projects? |

| Keyword search company | - "COMPANY" AND ("Agile" OR "digital transformation" OR "DevOps" OR "business process improvement" OR "Cloud" OR "digital strategy") |

| Leadership Focus | - Find articles of leadership through boolean searches and ask propose how we can help them achieve these goals |

| Company News | - Celebrate company achievements |

| Check support tickets | - Are they experiencing issues that upgrading deployment options could help resolve? |

| Mutual Contacts | - Do you have mutual contacts on LinkedIn you can talk about? |

| Use cases on website | - Do they have the same customers as us? How do they help them? |

| Speak to a user of the tool to create personalized message to decision maker | - Speak to someone who uses our tools every day to uncover pain-points (performance degradation at peak times) and take that information to a decision maker |

BDR Territory Movement Rules of Engagement

When a territory moves from one BDR to another but the previous BDR remains with the same team (ex: moves from one MM territory to another) the BDR vacating the territory will have the chance to temporarily retain ownership of accounts with which they have generated ongoing engagement (subject to manager approval). At the time of the holdover, an issue will be created that will be reviewed in 30 days to verify account ownership. This includes:

- The outgoing BDR will be allowed to hold back for 30 days any account with which they can demonstrate two-way engagement that could potentially lead to an IQM and new opportunity. If, after 30 days, no IQM has been set and no stage 0 opportunity exists, the account will be moved by the manager to the new BDR assigned to the territory. If the outgoing BDR is successful in generating a new opportunity, the account will remain with them until the opportunity is either qualified or unqualified.
- The outgoing BDR will be allowed to hold back for 30 days any account with which there is an existing stage 0 opportunity where they are listed as the BDR. After 30 days if the opportunity is not qualified, the account will be moved by the manager to the new BDR assigned to the territory.
- In instances where an account has been reassigned to the new BDR and the outgoing BDR had two-way engagement more than 30 days ago with the account but was unable to convert them to an SAO, and the account later returns unprompted and with no prior activity from the new BDR assigned to the territory and wants to pursue a conversation with sales, the team (manager) will receive SAO credit from any resulting opportunity.
- Any other situations that arise which result in a credit dispute will be investigated and resolved by the BDRs' leader and senior leader.

Assigning SAO Credit when a Territory Change is Uncovered during Discovery

There will be times when an SDR or BDR is working a prospect and, after connecting with the prospect, discovers that the corresponding account actually belongs to a different segment than originally thought. This could be due to newly uncovered information regarding employee count, HQ location, or parent account relationship. SAO credit in these situations will vary based on the circumstances and will be determined on a case-by-case basis. Specifically:

- If the SDR or BDR has done their due diligence to verify account information and still ends up finding an opportunity outside of their territory: as long as the related account isn't an AWA and there is no related activity from an SDR in the past 30 days, and the SDR or BDR's manager has verified that the accurate information could not have been uncovered prior to engaging with the prospect, then that SDR or BDR and their team will get SAO credit.
- If the related account is an AWA or there is related activity from an SDR in the past 30 days, SAO credit will belong to the BDR assigned to the AWA or the SDR working the lead related to the account.
- If the related account isn't an AWA and there is no related activity from an SDR in the past 30 days, but the SDR or BDR's manager determines that the accurate information should have been uncovered prior to engaging with the prospect, SAO credit will be assigned to the team manager assigned to the correct territory.
- Any other situations that arise which result in a credit dispute will be investigated and resolved by the SDR or BDR's leader and senior leader.

In situations where an SDR or BDR has received conflicting information and it is unclear what the correct territory is for an account, they should Chatter the AEs assigned to the potential territories and have them figure out who owns it.

Working with Resellers

The end-user account determines the BDR/SDR alignment: If you are the SDR assigned to the 3rd party lead, please gather the information in point 1 and pass the lead to the correctly assigned BDR (the BDR assigned to the end-user account) who will complete points 2-6

[illegible]

the new opportunity > save |
| Update the opportunity | - Change the business type to new business
and stage to pending acceptance.
 - Under contacts, add the reseller contact, role as
reseller, and primary contact.
 - Under partners, add the reseller account as VAR/Reseller
|

SDR/BDR to AE SAO Handoff Process

The purpose of the BDR-AE outbound handoff process is three fold.

- Ensure Outbound prospects get the best experience possible.
- Ensure the BDR team enjoys operational efficiencies and have clearly structured ways to collaborate with the AE team on outbound accounts.
- Ensure the AE team is set up for success is receiving outbound leads in a structured manner and have the appropriate information to utilize in converting them.

To make sure that the hand-offs maximize internal efficiencies, it is required that:

- The BDR team makes sure to book calls, with a minimum notice time of 48 business hours.
- The BDR team makes sure to properly fulfil Outbound SAO criteria, or work with AE to create a mutual command plan.
- The AE team makes sure to:
 - Accept SAOs within 8 working hours after an IQM call.
 - To leave a chatter note on the opportunity record, tagging BDR and AE manager with feedback on the level of qualification and handoff in case of discrepancies.
 - To be responsible for managing the prospect relationship after all handoff types have taken place. This includes re-scheduling conflicts.

1. BDR Qualified Meeting

- Are leads that have been qualified by the BDR over a Discovery call.
- CoM principles have been applied to the call and some of the Before/After Scenarios, Positive Business Outcomes, Requirements and Metrics have been identified and agreed upon between the prospect and the BDR.
- There is a clear need or intent identified from the side of the company, and the prospect has clearly articulated a path to the ultimate decision-maker, as per the guidelines for outbound SAO criteria.

BDR steps after discovery call

- Summarize CoM principles uncovered during the call
- Schedule next step through Groove while being on the call with the prospect
 - Meeting Type should be a 45' Call and the body of invitation should be adjusted to meet the prospect's needs.
- Send AE Intro Email
 - For demanding hand-offs, customer-facing agenda may also be copied and attached to intro email.
- Log Required SFDC fields and populate Notes field.
- Unless there's a scheduling conflict for the BDR, attend Evaluation Orchestration Call and kick-off the call:

- Summarize the BDR qualifying conversation by mentioning and verifying the before and after scenario of the prospect, as transcribed on the SAO notes.
- After prospect acknowledges that their internal situation have not changes in between BDR and AE call, recap the expectations and metrics as transcribed on the SAO notes and handoff to AE to move forward.

2. Joint IQM

- Are meetings booked with leads that are from pre-agreed upon Actively Working Accounts.
- Calls scheduled for these prospects will be taken as a joint IQM with both BDR and AE attending, and leading the qualification.
- CoM principles will be applied during the call, with the goal of uncovering a clear need and path to the ultimate decision-maker, as per the guidelines for outbound SAO criteria.

BDR steps before discovery call

- Schedule next step through Groove while being on the call with the prospect, and schedule straight to the AEs calendar.
- Meeting Type should be a 15' Discovery Call.
- Create SFDC opportunity, and log any pre-determined or relevant information from your past reeseach.
- Communicate with AE, and create a mutual command plan for the call.
- When kicking off the call, summarize the BDR research and reason for reaching out, such compelling events, Persons with LIM, etc
- After prospect acknowledges their compelling event and internal situation, discovery call continues with pre agreed upon structure with AE.

Organizing a Group Demo

Organizing a shared demo makes it more simple for us to offer spontaneously a demonstration of GitLab, which should result in a easier handover of opps, and ease to create opps. As BDRs, we arranged the execution of this demo by creating a zoom webinar, and configuring the whole event so that the administrative side is automated.

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| |
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|-----|-----
|-----|-----
|-----|
| Define the criteria that qualifies an opportunity as eligible to go to a shared demo.
|
|

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| SAL/AE is involved only | The SAL can
invite his/her/their customers or contacts in order to add value to their ongoing discussion,
if the AE/SAL finds it relevant. This is in the context of a conversation with the
prospect/customer.
|

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| SAL/AE and BDR are involved | The BDR
schedules a discovery meeting with the SAL (whether it is a prospect or customer) that

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generates a qualified opportunity. Once the opportunity is created, the SAL/BDR suggests the shared demo instead of the individual demo based on the priority of the opportunity (importance of the account, number of licenses, amount of the opportunity, persona). This is in the context of a conversation with the prospect/customer. There needs to be an opportunity in this case to suggest the demo, for the sake of collaboration between the SAL and the BDR. |

| BDR is involved only | When a lead with decision power or significant influence in the org (no individual contributor) expresses a high interest for GitLab (aka: high read/open rates on an email, response received by phone with interest confirmed) AND when the BDR has a tangible reason to think that there is a need in the division/team/company (research, information obtained through other leads in the same org), the BDR can leverage the shared demo for HOT leads to create interest or a sense of urgency, the goal being to have the lead jump on an introductory meeting after the shared demo. |

| Define the criteria for different groups of attendees who can join this demo

|

|

| Attendees coming from a BDR conversation | In order to attend a demo, this attendee needs to be part of an opportunity in at least stage 1- Discovery.

|

| Attendees coming from the AE's conversations | The AE can leverage this shared demo to invite his own contacts.

|

| Step-by-step guide to plan a demo

|

|

| 1. Get a Zoom Webinars license | You don't have a Webinar licence by default, so you need to open an access request issue on GitLab to ask for one.

|

| 2. Go on Zoom SSO > Webinars (on the left under Meetings) > Schedule a webinar | You will be able to save the entire configuration of the webinar as a template, in order not to set it up again.

|

| 3. Change the topic, description, date/time, and duration | Change the topic (this will be the title of your demo, and the name of the event on Google Calendar), the description (describes the content of the demo, the idea is to adapt the focus of the demo depending on your attendees), set the date/time of the demo, and the duration (note that setting a certain duration will not stop the zoom webinar once the time has gone). |

| 4. Tick the box 'Required' next to registration |

|

| 5. Change the Dial country to match attendees' language |

|

| 6. Configure additional settings such as Q&A, recording, and email settings |

|

| 7. Save the configuration as a template for future use |

|

Outbound Account Ranking Matrix

This complementary table can help structure your thinking around what outbound accounts to choose.

Account Scoring & Prioritization
Priority 1 Actively Working Accounts (15%)
- Strong ICP Qualities
- Compelling Triggers
- Strategy is Tailored and Targeted
- Future based next step dates
- Specific next step notes
Priority 2 Actively Working Accounts (35%)
- ICP qualities
- No Triggers
- Strategy is Targeted (persona/industry based)
- Future based next step dates updated weekly/bi-weekly
- Next step notes should just include week
Priority 3 Actively Working Accounts (50%)
- ICP qualities
- No Recent Triggers
- Strategy is nurture based
- Future based next step dates updated monthly
- Next step notes should just include recent release or event invite
Other Good Account Scoring Qualifiers:
- Current CE Usage
- 250+ employees in IT/TEDD positions
- Good Fit Industry / Vertical (High Growth, Technology, Financial, Healthcare, Regulated Business)
- Early Adopters / Innovative IT Shops (Identifiers & Keywords): Kubernetes / Containers, Microservices, Multi-cloud, DevOps, DevSecOps, CICD (and open-source + proprietary tools), SAST / DAST, Digital Transformation
- Current DevOps Adoption (multiple DevOps roles on staff or hiring for multiple DevOps positions)
Outbound Prospecting Framework

Priority Level	Account Strategy Includes	Next Step Date	Next Step Notes
Priority 1	Priority , Any Details	Future based next steps	Hyper-personalized, simultaneous outreach, creative, direct mail, ads, groundswell, events
Priority 2	Priority , Weekly Plan or Length of Groove Flow	Future based next steps depending on account strategy	Include the weeks outreach and overall strategy
Priority 3	Priority	Update Next Step Date to next months outreach	BDR Next Step, What kind of nurture (Product Updates, Events, Ect)

Growth Strategies, Ranking and RoE

Strategies:

- Growth within an existing customer account: BDR should strategically partner with SAE/ISR to identify additional business units to bring into the conversation as growth opportunities. Renewal dates should be exploited.
- Expansion into parent/children/subsidiaries of existing customer accounts: These are accounts that fall within the corporate hierarchy within Salesforce. If a child/subsidiary account is identified via ZoomInfo but not in our system, then BDR should follow the following process:

Create a LEAD for that account and then convert to CONTACT to create the ACCOUNT when you qualify your first lead.

- Free to paid upgrades: Existing Core/CE users can be targeted to upgrade to a paid version of GitLab

Ranking and prioritization of accounts:

- Rank 1: Expand with Purpose (EwP) accounts should be closely/strategically worked with SAEs. These accounts have High 6Sense intent scores and should therefore be High touch by BDR.
- Rank 2: ICP Ultimate parent accounts that have Core/CE-Users in a hierarchy, Total CARR/LAM for account, Med/Low 6Sense intent scores, and small renewals in current FQ.
- Rank 3: As above but are not our ICP

Professional Services Opportunities

A Professional Services Opportunity will be used to cover any integration, consulting, training or other service that a Sales rep will sell to a prospect/client and needs or wants to be invoiced separately. To invoice separately a new quote and opportunity must be created.

Frequently Used Terms

Term	Definition
Accepted Lead	A lead that an SDR or BDR agrees to work until qualified in or qualified out
Account	An organization tracked in salesforce.com. An account can be a prospect, customer, former customer, integrator, reseller, or prospective reseller
AM	Account Manager
AE Enterprise	Account Executive, can be Major or Strategic in AMER/EMEA
APJ	Asia-Pacific
BDR	Business Development Representative - focused on outbound
CAM	Channel Account Manager
CS	Customer Success
DACH	Germany, Austria and Switzerland region
EMEA	Europe, Middle East, and Africa
EULA	End User License Agreement

High intent evaluation	An event, webcast, demo that is a strong indicator of purchase or
High Priority Lead	Leads related to a high priority campaign.
Inquiry	An Inbound request or response to an outbound marketing effort
IQM	Initial Qualifying Meeting
LATAM	Latin America (includes all of Central & South America)
META	Middle East, Turkey and Africa Region
MQL	Marketing Qualified Lead - an inquiry that has been qualified through systematic means (e.g. through demographic/firmographic/behavior lead scoring)
MVC	Minimal Valuable Change (not Model View Controller)
NEUR	Northern Europe Region
NORAM	North America
Qualified Lead	A lead that a BDR or SDR has qualified, converted to an opportunity and assigned to a Sales Representative (Stage 0-Pending Acceptance)
RD	Regional Director
ROW	Rest of World
SAE	Strategic Account Executive
Sales Admin	Sales Administrator
Sales Serve closes the deal	A sales method where a quota bearing member of the sales team
SAO	Sales Accepted Opportunity - an opportunity Sales agrees to pursue following an Initial Qualifying Meeting
SDR	Sales Development Representative - focused on inbound
Self Serve	A sales method where a customer purchases online through our web store. Also known as a "web direct"
SEUR	Southern Europe Region
SLA	Service Level Agreement
SQO	Sales Qualified Opportunity

CSM	Customer Success Manager
TEDD	Technology, Engineering, Development and Design - used to estimate the maximum potential users of GitLab at a company
Won Opportunity	Contract signed to Purchase GitLab
Hyper-personalization	The concept of combining real-time data extracted from multiple sources to create outreach that resonates with prospects on an individual level.
VIP (prospect)	A Very Important Person, top officer, executive buyer, C-level prospect, or important influencer requiring hyper-personalization.
Influencer (prospect)	An individual prospect suspected to be involved with IT decision-making, tooling, teams, roadmap, strategic projects, and/or budgets.
User (prospect)	A prospect with limited influence within an IT organization.
Groundswell	An outbound strategy focused on filling the top of the funnel by generating engagement, opt-ins, MQLs, and uncovering intent signals.
Warm Calling	The method used to strategically incorporate phone calls and voicemails into an outbound prospecting workflow.
Rules of Engagement (RoE)	Defines ownership of a lead, SAO credit, and collaboration between SDRs and BDRs.
BDR Prospecting Status	Salesforce status includes Queued, Actively Working, Worked in FY, and Restricted.
Vartopia Partner Account	If populated, the lead/contact is worked by a partner, and Sales Dev should not proceed with outreach.
Actively Working Status	Accounts chosen for strategic outreach based on alignment, news, initiatives, etc. Recycles after 10 weeks if not worked.
Actively Working Status Requirements	BDR Account Strategy field must be populated. Research and Next Steps notes within 10 days. Minimum 5 people in Flows.
Queued status	Accounts waiting to be moved into Actively Working. SDRs work MQLs in this status.
Worked in FY status	Indicates an account went through "Actively Working" this FY. Can be moved back to "Actively Working" later.
Restricted status	SAE-indicated restriction on the account. BDRs handle the status change, note the reason, and reroute to assigned BDR.

Sales Development Tools

This page is to act as your guide to the many tools and best practices that the Sales Development Organization utilizes.

Claude

Claude is an AI assistant from Anthropic. It can help with analysis, content writing, research, spreadsheet organization and other tasks.

Claude Sales Dev BDR/SDR User Guide

- Prompt Library - a place to find prompts the Sales Dev Org is currently using and collaborating on
- Business Development Prospecting Claude Project
- AMER Calling Analysis Claude Project
- EMEA Calling Analysis Claude Project
 - Report Template for Calling Projects
 - Above are some examples of how information can be stored to a pre-made project. Pre-made prompts are also saved and shared on the same project in the Activity tab of this Project. Please feel free to use and/or duplicate this Project and the Saved Prompts for your purposes. We have the salesdevclaudeinsights Slack channel or the Prompt Library Issue that you can use to report your wins to the team.

Limitations

- Claude can't access GitLab systems, databases, or customer information directly. While Claude can analyze data you share, it can't pull anything from GitLab's internal tools or CRM. Adding up to Orange Data has been approved.
- Claude can't maintain context between conversations - each chat starts fresh, so previous discussions about prospects or strategies won't be remembered.
- Understand that Claude is not always right and will sound very confident even when it is wrong

General Tips

- Treat it like you are having a conversation with a highly intelligent robot (ex. C3P0)
- Always try to ask follow up questions to get better answers
- You can always have Claude write ideal prompts for you!
- Because Claude's data cut off is from April you can upload up to date target account's 10Ks, annual reports, and investor letters for up to date research
- You can use Claude to help you reformat your spreadsheets! It is recommended to upload your data in CSV format.

Examples of Questions to Ask

- "Can you see if this companies' annual report mentions DevOps, Software, Cyber Security, Git?"
- "Can you make this email reply more concise?"

- ·Let's say I was a sales rep from GitLab. How should I approach this company/title?· (Can use Panos's prompt in the prompt library as well)
- ·Can you explain why you gave x answer?·
- ·Can you rewrite that in a more casual tone?·
- ·I do not like that message you generated.Can you give me 3more options and explain the pros and cons of each?·

ZoomInfo

Zoominfo provides our Sales Development Representatives and Account Executives with access to hundreds of thousands of prospects and their contact information, company information, tech stack, revenue, and other relevant data. Individual records or bulk exports can be imported into Salesforce using extensive search criteria such as job function, title, industry, location, tech stack, employee count, and company revenue. More information can be found on the Marketing Operations Zoominfo handbook page.

ZoomInfo Training Resources

- ZoomInfo University: 40 Minute Introduction Video
- GitLab Edcast: ZoomInfo Introduction Training
- GitLab Edcast: ZoomInfo Advanced Training
- ZI 101 Video: Quick Saved Searches
- ZI 101 Video: Leveraging List Match
- ZI 101 Video: Tagging Prospects in LinkedIn
- GitLab Handbook: Zoominfo handbook page

LinkedIn Sales Navigator

LinkedIn Sales Navigator is a prospecting tool & extended reach into LinkedIn Connections.

LinkedIn Training Resources

- LinkedIn Intro: 70 Minute Navigator Tutorial
- GitLab Edcast: LinkedIn Navigator Training
- GitLab Video: Peer Tips
- GitLab Video: LinkedIn Personalization
- GitLab Video: Loading Accounts from Salesforce into LinkedIn

6Sense

6Sense is a targeting and personalization platform that we use to reach our different audiences based on intent data and our ideal customer profiles. While the content below is more specific to our Sales Development team, please visit the Marketing Operation's handbook page here for a full breakdown of 6Sense's functionality.

6Sense Training Resources

- General 6Sense Resources
- 6Sense for BDRs Video
- 6Sense Account Identification Guide

- 6Sense Persona Identification Guide

6Sense 6QA Automations

We currently have in place an automation that will automatically move accounts that reach 6QA status from 6Sense to SFDC.

Specifically:

- Accounts flagged as 6QA from 6Sense, whether they already exist on our system or not, will automatically be marked with the fields:
 - BDR Prospecting Status: Actively Working
 - BDR Account Strategy: Showing Intent
- These Accounts will be flagged on 1:1 dashboards for team members to review with an expected SLA of 48 hours
- While these accounts are automatically switched to Actively Working to indicate the high propensity to buy, team members need to still review and accept or dispute a 6QA account.
 - For FY26Q1 we are adding a Dispute Reason for Low LAM Dev Count which team members can use when they opt to not pursue a 6QA account because of a small account value potential.
 - Any accounts that team members choose to dispute using the instructions below will be flagged to the Action Needed dashboards for Managers to keep track of.
- Accepting or Disputing accounts can be done through a secondary field titled 6QA Acceptance Status where the options Disputed (would need to provide reasoning) or Accepted can be found.
- Any accounts that marked as Accepted by the BDR team will trigger the ZoomInfo workflow here to automatically bring relevant decision-makers for these accounts to the B6 view on SFDC.
- This is a complementary automation for the outbound team to automatically source some prospects for you. you are still expected to properly add the account to your pipeline following the steps outlined above.

Qualified

Qualified is the Sales Dev Org's tool we use to chat with visitors on the GitLab website. Currently the SDR teams primarily respond to inbound chats and visitors using Qualified. The BDRs also have the ability to initiate chats with known leads from their actively working accounts.

Gong

Refer to the Gong handbook page for full details on how Gong is leveraged at GitLab.

Sales Development Org team members are provided with Gong collaborator licenses for visibility to recorded sales conversations.

SDR and BDR team members are able to leverage the Gong Meeting option when creating meeting invites for prospects and customers. By using this option and adding an Account Executive with Gong recorder access to the meeting invite, Gong will leverage the AE's recorder access to record the meeting, assuming all meeting participants consent to record. More details about the Gong consent page can be found in the Gong internal handbook page. Once the recording is processed, the Account Executive that was added to the invite will be listed in Gong as the

host and owner of the call with the SDR or BDR as an attendee.

Crayon Competitive Messaging Resources

Crayon hosts competitive messaging resources that are maintained by GitLab's product marketing team.

This is where you can find messaging related to GitLab vs some of our competitors such as GitHub, Atlassian, and Azure DevOps

UserGems

UserGems is a tool that tracks specific cohorts of people that we provide in terms of them changing jobs. This automated tracking provides valuable insights, surfacing warm leads that can drive faster, larger wins. This tool helps mitigate deal risks when key individuals leave accounts, and accelerates deal progress when influential contacts join new organizations.

1. When a person that we are tracking leaves their current place of employment

- These people are identified by the lead initial source being UserGems Contact Tracking
- UserGems will track that person to their new role and will automatically create a lead with their new details in our system.
- These leads will be flagged on the Action Needed BDR dashboards for you and your manager's review, as well as on the B2 views
- We expect that our standard RoE will be followed normally in actioning these leads, similar to MQLs.
- These leads will be routed to the BDR team if:
 - They are associated to an Actively Worked Account
 - Are connected to a Pursuit Account, or an account that has been marked as 6QA by 6Sense
- The rest of the leads that do not fit these parameters will be routed round-robin to the SDR team.
- These leads should also be considered as intent data for prospecting an outbound account.
 - Take the time to research accounts for the propensity to purchase and intent signals. Could the tracked contact's hire into that account be a compelling event for you to use?
 - This data can be found either on our 1:1 Dashboards on report 6 that's dedicated to UserGems, or through this lead-level SFDC template that you can clone and use.
 - Analyze the hiring and promotion patterns as business signals.
 - A surge in technical hires (e.g., developers, engineers) may indicate growth initiatives, product development, or a focus on scaling infrastructure.
 - Sales or customer success hires could suggest plans to expand revenue through growth or enhance customer retention strategies.
 - Senior Leadership hires may indicate an internal restructuring of a department or a new business initiative.
 - Use these hiring signals to identify potential challenges or priorities, such as team collaboration, scaling efficiently, or driving revenue growth. Based on these, target decision-makers who are likely overseeing these initiatives, like directors or VPs.
- We'll also notify you via Slack and email about these Job Changes.

2. When a company that we are tracking gets a new hire or promotion

- These people are identified by the lead initial source being UserGems - New Hires and Promotions
- These people will be automatically be enrolled to a fully automated AI-driven sequence as per the guidelines below.
- Similar to above, the same people will be flagged on dashboards and reporting for you to consider as intent signals to add their respective accounts to your pipeline.
- We expect that our standard RoE will be followed normally.`
- We are actively working to remove irrelevant prospect titles from being created as part of the UserGems - New Hires and Promotions lead sources. If you notice any titles that you feel should not have been created because they're irrelevant to DevOps decision-making in that company, please feel free to use the usergems-feedback Slack channel to let us know, and we'll work with our CSM to review them.
- In the meantime, you can also mark these leads as Status Disqualified and Disqualified reason No Authority

3. When people leave or join accounts where we have open opportunities

- While we are actively working to improve our back-end so that this cohort can be visible on our dashboards, like the use-cases above, we are relying on sending notifications only for these people. In the meantime, you can use the report here to gauge what prospects we have on this list. We are currently notifying:
 - The Sales team for people that joined or left a stage 3 or beyond opportunity.
 - The Sales and Sales Development teams for people that joined or left a stage 0, 1 or 2 opportunity.
- These people are not enrolled to a specific flow, since there multiple scenarios on how to best address them, please search Groove for templated messages like this one that you can use.

Gem-E FY26 Auto Enrollment

For FY26Q1 we will pilot auto-enrolling UG leads to a dedicated Groove Flow which will make sure of UserGem's AI functionalities.

- Leads that have no activity, and match the filters on the SMB report here or MM/ENTG report here will be automatically added to either an SMB or MM/ENTG flow.
- These flows will automatically include AI generated customisation. Please review the slides or the video presentation here for a full walkthrough.
- These leads will be flagged on the dashboards similar to the explanation above and progress can be tracked from there.

Gem-E Meeting Assistant

As part of our Gem-E pilot, we are also trialling UserGems Meeting Assistant. The Assistant integrates with your calendar invitations and automatically pulls the contact information of people that are attending your call, but are not in our database yet. These people will be created as net new contacts and leads in SFDC, using the initial source UserGems - Meeting Assistant. They can be assigned to the existing account or opportunity that you are working on, so you can continue multi-threading the account that you are working on.

Sales Dev Manager Resources

Sales Dev Operations Team Regional Availability

The Global Sales Dev Operations team has the office hours below, so that regional team members can know how to address internally. Please tag the DRI below in the salesdevglobal slack channel to maintain our shared reality and other GitLab TeamOps tenets..

Please do feel free to reach out to anyone in the ops team based on their availability (Out Of Office etc), and your local time (ie. if you're in EMEA after hours and need someone ASAP, Ed in AMER can assist.)

Region / Timezone	Ops Team Member
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AMER	Ed Bao
EMEA / APJ	Panos Rodopoulos (Ed Bao is complementary DRI for APJ)

Sales Dev Operations Recurring Team Visits

The Sales Dev Ops team aims to visit each team's meeting once per month to be of assistance with anything operations related as required. Please find a link to an issue that we use for planning and feedback [here](#).

Sales Dev Operations Working Sessions

The Sales Dev Ops team also holds recurring weekly working sessions, with up to four participants per session. These sessions are aligned to the month's theme outlined above, and are designed to collaborate on key operational topics and initiatives.

Sales Dev Research Desk

Our Sales Dev Ops team can help you with researching our suite of databases (Sales Nav, ZoomInfo, Cognism, 6Sense) to help you manage your actively worked account list. We typically focus on accounts that are not currently available to our database, but can help with other ideas that you may have. Please log an issue to our board [here](#) using the template [BDRResearchRequest](#)

Sales Dev Housekeeping Issue

The team has an issue where we consolidate our monthly to-dos (titled Monthly Housekeeping). In this issue there's also a section for any feedback that we gathered that month, so we can plan any next steps. If you'd like to add feedback directly please navigate to our team's board, find this month's issue and log any feedback you have there.

Manager Tool Certification

We have an end-to-end process and tool walkthrough that walks manager through all the knowledge and information they need to know to be able to use our tech stack, both for inbound and outbound processes. The full walkthrough of this training is documented on the issue [here](#).

Moreover, abbreviated notes of the training can be found here and a list of questions that we expect our Managers to be able to answer here.

General leadership principles

This page will serve as a training resource and operational guide for current and future managers. All Sales Development Managers should follow the general leadership principles set out in the handbook.

- 1-1s
- Providing regular feedback
- Dealing with underperformance

Manager Onboarding

Onboarding is essential for all Sales Development Managers at GitLab. As part of onboarding, a Becoming a GitLab Manager issue will be created for each manager when they join, or are promoted. This issue is intended to connect new managers with the crucial information they need, and ensure they have access to all the resources and training available.

Outbound BDR Process Manager Onboarding

The BDR process that we have defined here in GitLab is meant to provide a repeatable set of steps that an outbound BDR can follow to achieve results. It is very important for an onboarding manager to align themselves as quickly as possible to this process as it is a proven method that will help them manage their team in a efficient and data-driven way.

The BDR Process is explained step-by-step in the section here

For a newcoming manager, we provide the Manager attention needed boards that will be your main tool in understanding where your team is aligned to our BDR process, and where they need assistance.

To help structure your usage of the above, you can follow the steps below during your first month at GitLab while the document here will be your main go-to resource

| Action | Benefit |

| ----- | ----- |

| Clone the Action Needed Dashboard and edit each report to be exclusive to your team's names | Gives you a SSoT that you and your team can easily reference |

| Review the dashboard with your team, and discuss how the data on it connect to the BDR KPIs | Allows you to understand your team's level of maturity and each team member's current level of alignment to existing processes |

| Take note of any discrepancies or points of feedback from the team, either transcribe them to 1:1s for individual conversations or to the SDR Issue board for org-wide improvements | Enables you to filter between discrepancies that are caused because of a team member's lack of diligence that should be improved upon by the individual OR for discrepancies that were caused by an org-wide operational shortcoming that should be improved upon on a global scale. |

| Set realistic expectations with the team about adherence to org KPIs and set a review mechanism to go over them on a recurring basis | Helps maintain a repeatable structure of

accountability for your entire team |

1:1 Account and Lead Level Dashboard Coaching guidance

The table below can help with structuring how you perceive and action the 1:1 Dashboards we have on SFDC and Tableau, the below connect to the KPI page here. and the videos here and here are two quick complementary resources to walk you through how we use the dashboards.

Additionally this 5' video explains the purpose of these dashboards, while this 3' video walks you through a practical use case of how to use a report in these dashboards.

Dashboard	Component	Expectation/Action	Coaching Opportunity
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1:1 Accounts Dashboard	0. Queued Accounts	For accounts in AW (Actively Working):	 These accounts are to be cleared on a weekly basis by being moved to AWA status or by leaving a clear chatter note as feedback on why the account was not added to a prospecting pipeline. This should include datapoints from intent tools or another other SSoT as supporting evidence. Carefully vetting and working accounts that are queued by the Sales team will lead to better collaboration, and mutual accountability. Not only are we expected to timely review these accounts but to keep our counterparts accountable to their account ranking by providing data-driven feedback.
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1:1 Accounts Dashboard	1. Review Existing Pipeline	For accounts in AW:	 These accounts are currently in the team member's name. The total volume should not be over 125 for Mid-Market BDRs and 75 for Enterprise BDRs. As a priority these should be reviewed weekly and action should be taken accordingly to remove or update these accounts. When clicking into the report the team member can screen all the datapoints that can help them gauge the status of their accounts at a glance. Activity and Research fields can be combined with intent datapoints to quickly see which accounts should be reviewed further manually.
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1:1 Accounts Dashboard	2. Research Accounts to be Recycled	For accounts in AW:	 These reports are nearing their automated recycle date, which by default is two months after their actively started work date. This report acts as a fallback report to the report above. A BDR should have already reviewed these accounts as part of their actively working account screen done in the previous step. This report will act as a second reminder. In theory an outbound account will have received at least 30 days worth of outreach since most flows we use have at least a 30 day cadence. It's fine to leave an account in a team member's pipeline until it's removed automatically in hopes of getting some inbound MQLs assigned to the BDR. Regardless, there's a business decision to be made about whether expecting inbound MQLs is a sound strategy, based on the team members quota attainment and overall pipeline at the moment, and whether replacing the about to be expired for another account is a better route.
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1:1 Accounts Dashboard	3. Re-evaluate newly added flagged accounts	For accounts in AW:	 These accounts were recently added to a team member's pipeline but at least one of our intent tools flags it as a weak account in terms of intent data. In the spirit of hyper-targeted results, this account should be empty since all tools we have should agree that this account is good enough to be added to the team member's pipeline. If there are any accounts flagged it is wise to review them and ensure that they should indeed remain with the team member's pipeline.
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1:1 Account Dashboard	4. Check past opportunities for potential use	For accounts not in AW:	 These are past opportunities that could be reviewed for re-engagement. Closed: Lost opportunity re-engagement is one of the best converting sources of pipeline for our team. After having reviewed the pressing reports in the first three steps above, the quickest review to
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make to gauge some low-hanging fruit is this report. |

| 1:1 Account Dashboard | 5, 6 and 7. Assess high priority individuals | For accounts not in AWA:
 These three reports show individuals that connect to actively working accounts in the team member's pipeline. These should be reviewed and any relevant next steps or actions should be made on the account-level bdr notes. | These three reports show individuals with high intent data, engagement in marketing campaigns or recent with interesting moments. While it's not necessary that there has to be action on the specific individuals, their behavior can give significant queues into the current situation within an account. |

| 1:1 Account Dashboard | 8, 9, 10, 11 and 12. Review High Intent Accounts. | For accounts not in AWA:
 These reports split not-AWA accounts in a few different buckets. While there will be significant overlap, having multiple reports help prioritize how a team member can review their account list for new accounts to add to their pipeline. These reports should be reviewed weekly and the majority of AWA accounts should be sourced from one of these. | These reports all reference our intent based tools, existing RoE around pursuit accounts and should guide the decision-making of team members. Referencing these as a first step should create a lot of internal efficiencies in researching accounts. |

| 1:1 Account Dashboard | 13. Consider AE-ranked accounts. | For accounts not in AWA:
 This report visualises accounts as per the ranking that the sales team manually gave them. They should be reviewed after the team member has reviewed intent-based tools. | The Sales team does not have access to the same data as us so their manual research can be used a good fallback report to cross-reference against the reports in the previous steps. |

| 1:1 Account Dashboard | 14 and 15. Review individuals from not actively worked accounts | For accounts not in AWA:
 These reports show individuals from non-actively worked accounts that either have been part of a marketing campaign, or show strong intent signals. | These individuals should be approached as an indication that the account as a whole should be investigated for outbounding. |

| 1:1 Account Dashboard | 16. Review individuals in flight. | For a